BERKELEY INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL ELT

Homework guidelines

AY 2024-2025

…Students in Finland have the least amount of outside work and homework than any other student in the world...
…Finnish students also don't have tutors. Yet they're outperforming cultures that have toxic school-to-life balances without the unneeded or unnecessary stress.

Mike Colagrossi (2018) for the World Economic Forum.

After spending all day in school, our children are forced to begin a second shift, with more academic assignments to be completed at home...
…the status quo isn't supported by good research or basic values, and those values include a commitment to let kids be kids and provide them with time to grow socially, physically, emotionally and artistically—not just academically.

Alfie Khon (2025)The Case Against Homework

Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to eliminate the distinction between homework and classwork and to promote a more integrated and meaningful learning experience for all students.

Policy

All work that is assigned to students, whether it is completed in class or at home, is considered to be part of the regular school day. There will be no specific designation of homework.

Rationale

Research has shown that the **distinction between homework and classwork is artificial** and counterproductive. Students learn best when they are able to work at their own pace and in their own time. By eliminating the distinction between homework and classwork, students will be able to focus on their learning and to complete their work in a way that is most effective for them.

Implementation

Teachers will be responsible for designing learning experiences that are appropriate for all students and that allow students to work at their own pace. Teachers will also be responsible for providing students with the support they need to succeed, both in class and at home.

Exceptions

There may be rare occasions when a student needs to complete additional work at home. In these cases, the teacher will work with the student and the student's family to develop a plan that is appropriate for the student's individual needs.

Evaluation

The Curriculum Coordinator will evaluate the implementation of this policy each year and make recommendations for improvement as needed.

Parent Involvement

Parents are encouraged to support their child's learning at home by providing a quiet place to study and by talking to their child about their school day. Parents are also encouraged to contact their child's teacher if they have any concerns about their child's progress.

Conclusion

This policy is designed to create a more student-centred and supportive learning environment. By eliminating the distinction between homework and classwork, students will be able to focus on their learning and to achieve their full potential.

References:

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